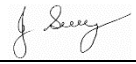


SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods , plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman:	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	Combination Vacuum Truck & Working at Heights	Project:	
SWMS prepared Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	 Signature
			<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L Likely	M Moderate	U Unlikely
H (1) (High level of harm)	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) (High)	1	1	2
M (2) (Medium level of harm)	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) (Medium)	1	2	3
L (3) (Low level of harm)	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) (Low)	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
1.0 Set out work area.	Struck by road or construction plant.	1	1. Barricade area off to restrict access and minimize plant working area as appropriate. 2. All workers to wear safety vests or high visible clothing with long sleeve shirt with sleeves down. 3. Operational flashing lights and reversing beepers on all plant. 4. Cordon off area underneath the drop/fall zone of the heights work with traffic cones and tiger tailed extendable barriers to prevent inadvertent access to the drop zone.	Supervisor All Operator	2
2.0 General Safety Requirements	Personal injury to operator and other workers.	1	1. All persons who are to operate or assist with the operation of the Combination Vacuum Truck are to be fully competent with Type B Jetting Operators certificate and have received information and instruction in the safe use of the machine and the potential hazards. 2. Read all instructions before using machine. 3. Know how to stop and start the vacuum and bleed pressure quickly. 4. Be familiar with controls. 5. Do not work in rain or during thunderstorms. 6. The vacuum is not to be operated by children, teenagers or persons under the influence of drugs or alcohol. 7. Operator and assistant to wear appropriate PPE – safety boots, safety glasses, long clothing, safety vests (done up to prevent entanglement) gloves, hearing protection and safety helmets where required. 8. If the vacuum is to be used with hazardous or dangerous materials- the operator must be adequately trained. 9. If there is a need to climb on top of truck ref to Working at Height SWMS.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
3.0 Working at Height	Fall from Height	1	1. The person undertaking the work at heights will be suitably trained and competent in RIIWHS204D <i>Work Safely at Heights</i> 2. The person working at heights will wear the appropriate clothing and footwear to prevent heat stress and slipping. 3. The observer will be on site at all times while work is being carried out. 4. No person will work on a ladder unless restrained by a pole strap or have 3 limbs on the ladder at all times. 5. Ladders are to be at an angle of 70 – 80 degrees, extend 1m beyond the access point and be secured top and bottom. 6. If scaffolding is to be used it must be installed by a competent person in accordance with the scaffolding plan and tagged accordingly. 7. Before work starts each day a competent person will check the work activity for the day -Weather conditions / proximity to other services. 8. All workers to be advised of any changes to the worksite before work commences. 9. WARNING: Never leave tools or equipment unsecured on the height surface/access points or roof	Supervisor All	2
4.0 Pre-working at heights survey	Fall from height	1	1. When conducting height surface pre-work walks/surveys the company representative shall note anchorage points for crews to use. 2. If no anchorage points or too few anchorages exist, the representative should inquire about the possibility of adding anchor points with the customer, client, owner, or general contractor. 3. In addition to anchorage points, height surface or roof access points shall be discussed with the following; the customer, client, owner, or general contractor.	Supervisor All Workers	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
5.0 Fall-Arrest Harness System	Fall from height	1	1. The fall arrest system must comply with the relevant standard. 2. Each anchor must be engineering designed. 3. Each anchor point must be inspected and approved by a competent person. 4. Each anchor point must be located so that a lanyard can be attached before the person moves into a position that they may fall. 5. Access to the fixing point will be by a ladder which will be fixed to prevent slipping. 6. There must be enough distance available to prevent the person hitting the ground if the person fell. 7. No person is allowed to use the system alone. 8. Consider emergency procedures should there be a fall to retrieve the fallen person – a WAH rescue plan is required! 10. The person using the system must be trained in its operation	Supervisor All Workers	2
6.0 Work on a Truck >2m in height	Fall from height	1	1. Where pneumatic fall protection guard rails are not fitted on top of a truck, the person working at heights shall ensure the following is complied with: 2. A safety harness must be fitted to trained and competent personnel working on top of the truck 3. A Slow Release Lanyard (SRL) must be used for this type of height work, not an inertia type lanyard. The SRL is to be fixed to an engineered anchor point on top of the truck via a Karabiner certified for the weight of the person. A spotter must be in place at all times while the work on top of the truck is carried out.	Supervisor All Workers	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
7.0 Safety harness fitting	Incorrect fitted harness could cause a malfunction	1	<u>Inspect Harness</u> • Check the straps for fraying, cuts or oil and grease contamination. • Check the buckles for any damage. Where the harness is damaged DO NOT USE and report situation to the Compliance Manager. <u>Prepare for Fitting</u> • Place the harness on the floor. • The "D" ring should lay flat on the floor. • Lift the leg loops to knee height and reach behind and grasp the " • Lift the ring and place arms through the shoulder straps. • Position the "D" ring near the base of the neck. • Grasp the shoulder strap, adjusting tabs in each hand. • Bend at the knees, keeping your back straight. • Pull down on the adjusting straps while in this position until they but not restrictive. • Stand erect. Adjust the weight belt. • DO NOT OVERTIGHTEN. • Secure the chest strap. <u>Remove Harness</u> • Reverse the fitting procedure. <u>Cleaning and Storage</u> • If soiled - wash the harness in a weak detergent solution and dry. • Store in a clean dry area away from any contaminates.	All Workers	2
8.0 Six Monthly Inspection	Fall from height	1	1. The complete fall arrest system must be tested every 6 months by a competent person. 2. Records are to be maintained for the lesser of 4 years or the life of the system.	Supervisor	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
9.0 Emergency Rescue - 000	Fall from height	1	1. Where a safe rescue method cannot be facilitated in accordance with the working at height rescue plan. Call Triple 000 and Follow guidance information from emergency services for rescue of a worker trapped in a safety harness.	Supervisor All Workers	2
10.0 House keeping	Falling or tripping over	2	1. Maintain good housekeeping especially hoses. 2. These should be restrained in conjunction with crane/lift with suitable restraints prior to operation of the truck 3. Barricade off unsafe areas.	Supervisor Operator	3
	Manual handling of vac hoses	2	1. Use boom where possible to move hose, to suit smooth vertical extension, use correct manual handling techniques. 2. Must be a two person operation to manage manual handling/fatigue risks.	Operators	3

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
11.0 Confined Space Entry	Confined space		3. If working in or near a confined space maintain three points of contact with hose and ground to prevent possibility of falling. 4. Follow Confined Space Entry SWMS when entry to confined space is required, complete confined space permit		
12.0 Pre start checks vacuum truck	Unsafe machine potential for injury to operator or bystanders	1	1. Pre start checks are to be completed as per the operations manual and documented as such.	Operator	2
13.0 Assemble the vacuum equipment	Manual handling Slips, trips, falls Failure of connections Kicking/moving hoses Vertical connections of hose People being caught on end of suction Static Electricity	1	1. Use boom where practical. 2. Position hose trailer as close to worksite as possible. 3. Use team lifting. 4. Use vacuum nozzles and fittings to reduce bending. 5. Each travis lamp to be checked and tapped if required. 6. Hose to be restrained along length to stop whipping. 7. Vertical connections to be tied between joints to prevent hose falling if clamp fails. 8. Personnel not to step over unrestrained hose lengths. 9. Barricade paths and work area. 10. Use crane or similar to raise/lower hose lengths where possible 11. Vertical connections to be secured with rope across join. 12. Area underneath and near vertical connections to be barricaded out to a distance to ensure no-one is underneath the potential fall path of hose if it fails. 13. Vacuum breaker must be fitted at final length of hose on worksite. 14. If remote is fitted then remote is also to be secured with Operator onsite. 15. Walk vacuum line to ensure safety & security along length of line to worksite. 16. NOTE: Earth out the unit using the static cable and stake.	Operators	2
14.0 Assemble Jetting/cleaning Equipment	Infection Sharp edges Manual handling Falling equipment High pressure water	1	1. Personal hygiene (wash hands prior to eating). 2. Wear gloves and remove sharp edges/burrs on equipment. 3. Use correct manual handling techniques. 4. Store equipment securely on vehicle. 5. Inspect hose daily and ensure it has been tested (6 monthly)	Operators	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			6. Never cap jetting hose. 7. Inspect jetting hose for damage. 8. Never adjust pump pressures or regulators. 9. Maximum reducer on 1 inch hose is ¾ inch. 10. No reducers on ½ inch hose. 11. Must be 3 metre leader hose on front of jetting assembly to identify end of jet assembly when removing from drain. 12. Fittings to be firmly secured use		
15.0 Operating the Vacuum truck	Injury to operator or bystanders – high pressure- dirt and stones can be flicked around.	1	1. Wear eye and ear protection. 2. Keep operating area clear of all persons. 3. Use a witches hat next to the water jet to prevent splashes. 4. Stay alert and beware of the force of the water pressure coming out the end of the hose and when using the vacuum hose be aware of the suction pressure. 5. Do not overreach or stand on unstable supports. 6. Never aim the jet in the direction of persons or animals as the water jet comes out of the nozzle at high speed with high pressure. 7. Do not leave the operating vacuum unattended. If the vacuum is not required switch off. 8. Do not operate the vacuum in enclosed spaces. 9. Follow directions as per the operations manual. 10. The pressure hose is operated with by trigger action. 11. When cleaning pipes etc. the hose must first be in the pipe prior to activating the trigger.	Operator	2
	Fire hazard	1	1. Do not use near flammable liquids. 2. Turn off machine prior to refueling.	Operators	2
16.0 Flushing and or vacuuming pits, pipes and plant	Striking pedestrians, members of the public or other workers Spraying debris causing injury Spraying debris causing property damage	1	1. Wear appropriate PPE for the site including gloves. 2. Ensure appropriate work area is cordoned off to prevent access by the public. 3. When deciding on appropriate work area take into account spray return and wind conditions. 4. Observe the hose as it is being fed into pipe or plant item. 5. Watch reel to ensure hose winds on correctly.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
	Whipping hoses		6. Ensure minimal slack in hose to prevent whipping. 7. Before hose leaves pit ensure the water is shut off. 8. Stand clear of hose when it is exiting pit or pipe as debris may be sprayed out. 9. Only uncover pits required for access as pit covers will prevent uncontrolled water or debris spray. 10. Never point pressure spray at any person.		
17.0 Hose blockage	Entrapped hand Manual handling	2	1. Do not use hand to unblock hoses. 2. Keep hands clear of hose. 3. Use two operators when handling hose when clearing blockages.	Operators	3
18.0 Finishing	Waste not cleaned up Manual Handling Slips, trips, falls	2	1. Ensure all waste is vacuumed up. 2. Use correct manual handling techniques. 3. Ensure manhole or pits are covered.	Operators	3
19.0 Pack Up Height Gear	Fall from height	1	1. Reverse all procedures in setting up the height gear	Operators	2
20.0 Shut down and Maintenance	Potential for personal injury	1	1. When finishing work follow end of day maintenance and shut down requirements. 2. When disassembling any part of the machine or servicing make sure the machine is turned off.	Operator	2

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers are available in WHS 05 emergency procedures. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tires/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refueling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat at all Times	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory Helmets if and when required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.				
All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card				
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle License's (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	Plant Operators license's or competency assessments where required	Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management	
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training	Fire Extinguisher training	Fatigue Management Training	

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)			
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022			
Codes of Practice and Other Guides			
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018
Guide for Managing Risks from High Pressure Water Jetting – Safe Work Aust 2012			

Plant & Equipment for this activity
- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site - Daily maintenance & service checks. - Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out. - Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity
Combination Vacuum Truck
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.